



Deadman College of Humanities and Science

Department of Economics

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Teaching Statement

My goal as an educator is to make economics clear and applicable for every student—so that after class, a student can go home and explain what they learned to their parents using a real-world example. My teaching philosophy rests on two principles: clarity about what we are doing and why, and learning by doing.

This passion began during my undergraduate studies, when I started helping classmates prepare for exams—walking them through concepts, math, and graphs on the whiteboard in the days before each test. Around the same time, in a Quantitative Methods course, I received a low grade on my first exam, along with roughly 95% of the class. Yet by the final exam, I answered every question correctly and earned the highest grade—which led to my appointment as teaching assistant for the course in subsequent semesters. My approach was simple: understand every step of a problem and the reasoning behind it, then practice it enough times that the process becomes natural. That philosophy has stayed with me since, including later as a teaching assistant for a Statistics course during my master's.

During my Ph.D., I served as lead teaching assistant for Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics, working across sections taught by different professors using different textbooks and pacing—a challenge I learned to manage with experience. The most rewarding moments were watching students grasp a concept, work through the math, or correctly interpret a graph for the first time, and later hearing that the study strategies I recommended had helped them earn the grade they wanted.

This fall, while on the job market, I am teaching Intermediate Microeconomics with an emphasis on high teacher-student interaction. After nearly every chapter, students work through problem sets in class with my guidance—checking whether a utility maximization problem is set up correctly, whether their intuition holds, and reinforcing what was just covered. These exercises also let me assess the class's level in real time and adjust the material to remain challenging but achievable.

Ultimately, I believe students learn best when abstract theory connects to real-world applications—understanding not just how to solve a problem, but why it matters. That excitement, once triggered, motivates students to keep learning, and it motivates me to keep improving as a teacher. When students have the tools, understand the reasoning, and have practiced enough to apply that framework to new situations, they carry economics with them far beyond the classroom.